

TAKING DAILY INVENTORY

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Develop a program of recovery that is free of addiction and the negative influences of antisocial behavior.
2. Take responsibility for own behavior.
3. Identify patterns of thought, emotion, and behavior that pose a threat to sobriety, and develop a plan of action for improvement.
4. Clarify the importance of taking inventory as part of preventing relapse.
5. Provide a method for taking inventory to continue using in the future.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE ANTISOCIAL BEHAVIOR

- Alternatives to Addictive Behavior
- Analyzing Acting-Out Behavior
- Being Genuinely Unselfish
- Correcting Distorted Thinking
- Early Warning Signs of Mania/Hypomania
- Getting Out of Myself
- Handling Tough Situations in a Healthy Way
- Respect or Fear?
- Understanding My Defense Mechanisms
- What Do I Want for My Children?
- What Price Am I Willing to Pay?
- What's Addiction Got to Do with My Problems?

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE USEFUL

- Relapse Proneness
- Substance Abuse/Dependence
- Treatment Resistance

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “Taking Daily Inventory” activity is designed for clients who are not inclined to introspection and who need prompting to self-monitor for addictive patterns of thought, emotions, and behaviors. It is designed to highlight a drift toward addictive patterns before actual relapse occurs, and is a good sequel to the exercise titled “Early Warning Signs of Relapse.” Follow-up could include reporting to the therapist or treatment group of trends noted by the client in his/her daily inventories, feedback from the therapist or group about discrepancies between what clients report and what they observe, and keeping a record of any consistent challenges identified.

EXERCISE III.B

TAKING DAILY INVENTORY

Your daily emotions, attitudes, and actions—positive and negative—move you either further into recovery or back toward drinking and/or using or other addictive behavior. Checking your progress frequently to identify risk factors and improvements is an important part of staying sober.

1. Using a scale in which 1 = low and 5 = high, score yourself daily on these items:

Moving Further into Recovery:

Honest with self _____

Honest with others _____

Living for today _____

Hopeful _____

Active _____

Prompt _____

Relaxed _____

Responsible _____

Confident _____

Realistic _____

Reasonable _____

Forgiving _____

Trusting of others _____

Content with self _____

Helpful to others _____

Moving toward Relapse:

Dishonest _____

Resentful _____

Depressed _____

Self-pitying _____

Critical of self/others _____

Procrastinating _____

Impatient _____

Angry _____

Indifferent _____

Guilty _____

Anxious _____

Ashamed _____

Fearful _____

Withdrawn _____

Demanding _____

2. How did you improve today?

3. What roadblock(s) to recovery/progress can you identify today?

4. Is there anything you wish you had done differently today?

5. What is your level of commitment to recovery today? (1 to 5 rating) _____

6. What did you learn about yourself today that you can use to assist continued progress?

7. Did you begin working on any new change today? If so, what is it?

Be sure to bring this handout back to your next session with your therapist, and be prepared to talk about your thoughts and feelings about the exercise.